

PLAN · PRACTISE · PASS

Twelve Weeks to the CASC

The plan, the practice, and the proof it is working.

However many weeks you actually have.

Passing the CASC is not about how much you know. It is about how you spend the weeks between now and the exam. Twelve weeks is the full route; eight, four and the resit are compressions of it. Start wherever you actually are.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- The twelve-week route — and how to compress it to eight or four
- Weekly planner, station log and domain tracker you fill in
- Mock debriefs, peer-practice structure, and the last fourteen days

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HOW TO USE THIS

Start here

This workbook is not more teaching. It is the instrument that decides how you spend the weeks between today and your exam, records what you actually do, and tells you what to fix next. Fill it in badly rather than not at all — a half-completed log still beats a perfect memory of how it felt.

THE ONE RULE

Work through it in order once, in about forty minutes, and you will leave with a dated plan. After that, you only need three pages each week: your planner, your station log and your domain tracker.

Everything in this workbook works without buying anything further. Where a paid option genuinely helps, it is named as one option among several — never as the only route.

Filling it in

The interactive version lets you type into every field and tick every box by typing an X. It works in Acrobat, Preview and most desktop readers; on a phone or tablet it depends on your PDF app. If typing does not work on your device, use the print version supplied alongside this one and fill it in by hand.

Name _____

Exam date _____

Weeks remaining _____

PART ONE

Where you are now

Before choosing a route, be honest about the starting point. This takes five minutes and it decides everything that follows. Nobody else sees it.

Your position

Attempt number _____

Previous score / feedback, if any _____

Stations practised out loud so far _____

People available to practise with _____

The honest questions

- ☐ I have practised at least one station out loud, with another person, in the last seven days.
- ☐ I can name the three domains I am weakest in without looking them up.
- ☐ I have watched someone else be marked, and understood why they lost the marks.
- ☐ I have a date, a place and a person for my next practice session.
- ☐ I have read at least one full station task aloud and timed myself at seven minutes.

WHAT I ALREADY KNOW IS WRONG WITH MY PREPARATION

THE MOST COMMON MISTAKE

Reading and watching feel like progress and are the cheapest form of preparation to consume. The CASC is a performance exam: it tests what comes out of your mouth under time, in front of someone. Candidates who fail have almost always read enough. Very few of them have spoken enough.

PART TWO

What actually moves the needle

Four things change your score. Every resource you can buy or borrow serves one of them, and most candidates over-buy the first and starve the other three.

1 • Knowledge

What to say and when — the structures, the frameworks, the phrases. Cheap to acquire, and the input most candidates already have enough of by the time they fail.

2 • Repetitions

Stations performed out loud, under time. This is the input that most reliably separates a pass from a fail, and the one that costs nothing but arrangement.

3 • Feedback

Someone telling you what they saw, against the domains the examiners use. Practice without feedback rehearses your errors until they are fluent.

4 • Exam-day behaviour

Timing, recovery after a bad station, reading the task properly, not panicking at minute five. Trainable, and almost never trained.

Choosing your resources

The categories below are what exist. No brand is named, because providers change and you should judge them yourself. Score each on the four inputs, then decide what you are missing rather than what looks appealing.

RESOURCE CATEGORY	GOOD FOR	WHAT IT CANNOT DO	USING IT?
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

HOW TO CHOOSE ONE

Ask four questions of anything you are about to pay for. How many times will I speak out loud per hour of it? Who is giving me feedback, and against what standard? Is it teaching me content I already have? And could I get the same thing free by organising three colleagues and a video call?

A rough guide: a self-study library and a peer group can carry most of your preparation. A taught course or a mock circuit is worth buying once you are already practising regularly — not as a substitute for it.

WHERE THIS WORKBOOK FITS

This workbook is the planning half of The CASC Academy. The teaching half is the station library: forty-three stations across the eight domains, each one built around a named trap, with two failing attempts and a passing one shown side by side, the examiner's reasoning at every decision, a timed Exam Mode, and a three-person practice pack with hidden role-player information.

The planner, the station log and the domain tracker in the pages that follow are written to be filled in from that library. They work with any material — but the domain numbers, the language and the marking they use are the library's.

PART THREE

Choose your route

Twelve weeks is the full route, and everything that follows is built for it. Eight and four weeks are compressions of the same plan, not different plans — they keep the practice and drop the reading. Pick the one that matches the weeks you actually have, not the one you wish you had.

- ☐ Twelve weeks — the full route. Two domains a fortnight, weekly peer practice from week two, a mock at week eight and week eleven.
- ☐ Eight weeks — compressed. Three domains a fortnight, peer practice twice weekly from week one, one mock at week six.
- ☐ Four weeks — triage. Stop reading entirely. Your weakest four domains only, practice out loud every second day, one mock if you can get one.
- ☐ Resit — start at Part Nine, then return here. Do not simply repeat what you did last time, only harder.

THE RULE THAT APPLIES TO ALL FOUR ROUTES

From today, no week passes without at least one station performed out loud in front of another person. Not read. Not watched. Performed. If you protect only one thing in your plan, protect that.

The weekly planner

One block per week. Set the focus on Monday, name the stations you intend to work through — the library is ordered so that a domain can be walked start to finish in a sitting — then record what actually happened and mark the week honestly. The gap between planned and done is the most useful data in this workbook.

WEEK 1

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 2

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 3

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 4

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 5

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 6

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 7

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 8

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 9

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 10

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 11

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

WEEK 12

Domain focus _____

Stations to practise _____

Practice booked with / when _____

DAY	WHAT I DID	OUT LOUD?	MINUTES
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	
		☐	

END OF WEEK — what went well, what did not, what changes next week

PART FOUR

The station log

Every station you perform out loud, logged. This page answers the only question that matters in week ten: have I actually done the work, and where am I still losing marks?

DATE	STATION	OBSERVED BY	WEAKEST DOMAIN	P/B/F

THE EIGHT DOMAINS

1 Communication & Rapport · 2 Information Giving · 3 Risk Assessment · 4 Mental State Examination · 5 Capacity, Consent & the Law · 6 Management & Emergencies · 7 Difficult Conversations · 8 Physical Examination

Each has its own hub in the Academy library, with its stations beneath it and the domain's founding failure set out at the top. Write the domain numbers in the left column in the order you intend to work on them — weakest first, and start at that domain's hub.

MY WEAKEST DOMAIN RIGHT NOW, AND THE SPECIFIC THING I DO WRONG IN IT

PART SIX

Mock debriefs

A mock without a structured debrief is an expensive afternoon. Fill one of these in within an hour of finishing, while you can still remember what you said.

MOCK 1

Date _____

Provider / format _____

Stations attempted _____

THE STATION THAT WENT WORST — and the exact moment it went wrong

WHAT THE FEEDBACK SAID — in their words, not your summary

THE ONE THING I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY — specific enough to practise this week

MOCK 2

Date _____

Provider / format _____

Stations attempted _____

THE STATION THAT WENT WORST — and the exact moment it went wrong

WHAT THE FEEDBACK SAID — in their words, not your summary

THE ONE THING I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY — specific enough to practise this week

MOCK 3

Date _____

Provider / format _____

Stations attempted _____

THE STATION THAT WENT WORST — and the exact moment it went wrong

WHAT THE FEEDBACK SAID — in their words, not your summary

THE ONE THING I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY — specific enough to practise this week

PART SEVEN

Practising with colleagues

This is the highest-value hour available to you, and it is free. It is also the one most often wasted, because three people meet without a structure and spend the hour discussing cases instead of performing them.

How to run a trio

Three people, three roles, rotating: candidate, role-player, observer. Fifteen minutes per person — seven for the station, eight for feedback read aloud. Three rotations fills an hour and gives everyone one turn in each seat. The observer marks against the domains and speaks first; the candidate does not defend; the role-player reports only what they experienced in the room.

- ☐ The observer forms a judgement — pass, borderline, fail — before ticking anything.
- ☐ One sentence of evidence out loud before the detail.
- ☐ Feedback goes domain by domain, and names the weakest domain as the next thing to practise.
- ☐ Nobody skips the role-player seat — watching a station from inside it teaches more than watching from outside.
- ☐ The session is booked for the next week before anyone leaves the call.

FINDING PEOPLE TO PRACTISE WITH

If you do not have two colleagues sitting the same diet, use the Academy's WhatsApp group. Everyone enrolled on the course is in it, from a range of deaneries and time zones, and it exists for exactly this: finding a trio, fixing a time, and swapping the stations you found hardest.

It is the fastest way to solve the problem that stops most candidates practising — not motivation, but finding two other people who are free on Tuesday evening.

Your practice group

NAME	CONTACT	TIME ZONE	USUAL SLOT

Sessions booked

DATE	TIME	WITH	STATIONS	DONE
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

DATE	TIME	WITH	STATIONS	DONE
				☐
				☐
				☐

PART EIGHT

The last fourteen days

The final fortnight has one job: protect what already works and stop acquiring anything new. Candidates lose marks in this window by panicking into new material rather than rehearsing what they have.

Days 14 to 4

- ☐ No new resources. Nothing bought, downloaded or started after today.
- ☐ Practice out loud every second day, minimum — short sessions are fine, silence is not.
- ☐ Rehearse openings and endings specifically: the first thirty seconds and the last thirty.
- ☐ One full timed run of at least six stations back to back, to build stamina.
- ☐ Re-read only my own station log and domain tracker — not new notes.

Days 3 to 1

- ☐ Logistics confirmed: travel, accommodation, ID, timings, and the route to the centre.
- ☐ One light practice session, then stop. No practice on the final evening.
- ☐ Sleep protected — treat it as part of the preparation, because it is.
- ☐ A plan for a bad station, written down: what I will say to myself, and how I will start the next one.

MY PLAN FOR THE STATION THAT GOES BADLY — written now, while I am calm

ON THE DAY

Every candidate has at least one station that goes badly. The pass is not decided by that station — it is decided by the two that follow it. Read the task twice. Take the four minutes. Start the next station as though the last one never happened, because to the examiner in front of you, it did not.

PART NINE

If it did not go your way

Most people who pass this exam did not pass it the first time. A failed attempt is information, and it is the most specific information you will ever get about your own performance. Use it before you re-book.

Before you do anything else

- ☐ I have read the feedback properly, more than once, and written down what it actually says.
- ☐ I have identified which domains failed — not which stations.
- ☐ I have accepted that repeating the same preparation harder is unlikely to change the result.
- ☐ I have told at least one person, because doing this alone makes it worse.

WHAT THE FEEDBACK SAID — in their words

WHAT I NOW THINK WENT WRONG — honestly, and in terms of behaviour rather than knowledge

WHAT WILL BE DIFFERENT THIS TIME — three specific changes

THE HONEST DIAGNOSIS

If you failed on knowledge, more reading may help. That is uncommon.

If you failed on structure, timing or communication — which is what most feedback describes — then reading will not touch it, and neither will another video course. What changes it is repetitions with feedback from someone who can see what you cannot: a colleague who marks you properly, a mock circuit, or coaching.

Working with me directly

This is one option among several, and it is not the one to start with. If you are not yet practising out loud every week, arrange that first — it is free and it will do more. Coaching is worth buying when a specific weakness has not shifted despite regular practice, or after a failed attempt.

What a session is

Sixty minutes, online, with me. You perform stations and I mark you the way an examiner does, then we work on the specific thing costing you marks. You leave with a written summary of what to practise and how. Small-group sessions run with a maximum of three candidates, so everyone performs in every session rather than watching.

Sessions and packages

ONE TO ONE · 60 MINUTES

Single session £120

Package of five £540 (£108 per session — saving 10%)

Package of ten £960 (£96 per session — saving 20%)

SMALL GROUP · 60 MINUTES · MAXIMUM THREE CANDIDATES

Single session, per person £60

Package of five, per person £250 (£50 per session)

BOOKING

Sessions are booked at medlexsolutions.com/casc-sessions

Bring your station log and your domain tracker to the first session. If you arrive with those two pages filled in, we spend the hour on what is actually wrong rather than on finding out.

WHAT I WANT FROM MY FIRST SESSION — the specific problem, not “help with the CASC”



ONE LAST THING

**The candidates who pass
are rarely the ones who
knew the most. They are
the ones who practised
out loud, on purpose,
with someone watching.**

Keep this workbook open. Fill it in badly rather than not at all.

The CASC Academy · by MedLex Foundations

Where Medicine Meets Justice